



FIRST BLOOD

IN A PICTURE that contrasts essential innocence and fragility with the implicit pain of a ritual act, a boy flagellates himself during a Moharram procession in Mumbai to mark Ashura. The day commemorates the death of Imam Hussein, grandson of Prophet Mohammad, who was killed in the 7th century battle of Karbala.

KOLKATA | Winds of Change

Post-Nano, Nandigram is in for a change of governance. Trinamool Congress's Firoza Bibi wiped out the ruling CPI(M)'s Paramananda Bharati by a huge margin of 39,549 votes, winning the Assembly by-poll as expected. Bibi is a member of the Trinamool-led Bhumi Uchhed Pratirodh Committee that had forced the state Government to stop its plans to take over land for industrial purposes last year. The state Government's excesses have clearly changed the political canvas here. The change began in May when Trinamool won the Panchayat elections. Trinamool chief Mamata Banerjee hailed Bibi's win as a victory for democracy and said it was a "people's victory". On March 14, her party would dedicate the win to the victims of Nandigram where villagers were gunned down by police on the same day in 2007. *by Elora Sen*



NANDIGRAM HAS PASSED ITS VERDICT ON THE NANO AFFAIR AND TURNED ITS BACK ON THE LEFT